INVESTMENT SNAPSHOT · TEAM & FINANCING VERIFIED

Koah

koahlabs.com · Founded 2024 · San Francisco, California, United States · active · Crustdata ID 3718859

Koah is the GenAI Ad Network:Publishers can monetize AI chat without compromising UX — and advertisers can reach high-intent users with 1:1 engagement inside GenAI environments.Native-built for AI, optimized for performance, and...

RUN LABELS

FIXTURE

model: recorded model responses (FIXTURE)

profile FULL | run 11

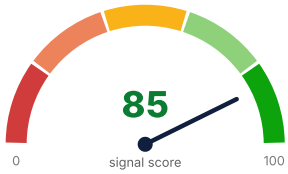
reviewed 2026-10-31

SIGNAL RATING

INVEST

Confidence: high

Horizon: Proceed now, subject to standard legal diligence



SUGGESTED ALLOCATION

$100K

of your $100K standard check (100%)

$0 $100K

HEADLINE FINDING

Strong traction signal with verified facts

HEADCOUNT

24

▲ +166.7% YoY

/company/enrich headcount.timeseries

WEB VISITORS / MONTH

17.2K

▲ +29.2% trailing 12 months

/company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['k...

TOTAL INDEXED FUNDING

$25.5M

Last: Series A · 24 Feb 2026 · $20.5M

indexed record (Crunchbase-derived) /compa...

REVENUE ESTIMATE

$0–$500K

■ +0% band midpoint

Estimate band, not reported revenue

/company/enrich revenue.estimated.lower_bo...

MONTHS SINCE LAST ROUND

8.2

Series A · 24 Feb 2026

computed from /company/enrich funding.mile...

FLAGS RAISED BY THE RULES

11

0 Critical | 0 Red | 3 Amber | 8 Green

fixed rules, identical for every company (page 7)

Why, in brief

- Score 85/100 · strongest: Traction (97) — headcount +167% YoY; web visitors +29% YoY
- Weakest: Market (67) — crowding medium (72 funded peers in 24 months); growing faster than peers
- Strength: Round matches the indexed record — C1 (series a): consistent with Crustdata's record.
- Strength: Round matches the indexed record — C3 (seed): consistent with Crustdata's record. Lead Forerunner is among the record's investors.
- Strength: 3 of 3 founders ID-joined to the company — Mike Choi, Nic Baird, Herrick Fang

Founders

Mike Choi · Co-Founder

Nic Baird · Co-Founder

Herrick Fang · Co-Founder

Rules-based signal computed from public sources and Crustdata's indexed data (including estimates). It is not financial advice and does not replace diligence, references or legal review. Private-company financial statements are not public; revenue figures are third-party estimates. Every figure carries its source; verified claims cite evidence IDs (E = source passage, G = Crustdata graph value) listed on page 7. Crustdata funding data is an indexed record (Crunchbase-derived), not an independent source.

2 Why this rating

Five pillars, fixed weights, fixed rules. Critical flags are about whether the facts hold; red flags are about the business.

PILLAR	SCORE (0–100)	REASONS
Team weight 25%	80	• 3/3 listed founders ID-joined to the company • more than one founder • notable prior employers
Traction weight 30%	97	• headcount +167% YoY • web visitors +29% YoY • followers +734% YoY
Market weight 15%	67	• crowding medium (72 funded peers in 24 months) • growing faster than peers
Financing weight 15%	86	• last round 8 months ago • 3 indexed rounds • announced round verified against the record
Verification weight 15%	88	• 4 verified sentences • 0 critical flags • 2 open points
Weighted score weights sum 100%	85	Rating **INVEST** · confidence high

Critical flags · verification and integrity 0

No verification or integrity problems found by the rules.

Red flags · business risks 0

No business-risk red flags fired.

Open points 3

⚠ **C2: holds with a qualification** The CEO title rests on the company's statement; the indexed profile shows only Co-Founder. E2 G3 `A1 verification-open`

⚠ **A sentence was withheld** C4 could not be verified as written from its cited evidence; the unsupported part was "the Series A brings its total funding". `A1 verification-open`

⚠ **Early revenue for capital raised** $25.5M indexed funding vs a revenue estimate of at most $0.5M (51x; third-party estimate) metric:total_funding_usd metric:revenue_band `A5 revenue-vs-capital`

Green flags 8

✓ **Round matches the indexed record** C1 (series a): consistent with Crustdata's record. G5 `G1 verified-round`

✓ **Round matches the indexed record** C3 (seed): consistent with Crustdata's record. Lead Forerunner is among the record's investors. G6 `G1 verified-round`

✓ **3 of 3 founders ID-joined to the company** Mike Choi, Nic Baird, Herrick Fang G2 G3 G4 `G2 team-joined`

✓ **Team growing fast** Headcount +167% year on year (now 24) metric:headcount_yoy_pct `G3 strong-growth`

✓ **Audience growing** Followers +734% year on year metric:followers_yoy_pct `G8 audience-growth`

✓ **Growing faster than peers** Headcount +167% YoY vs peer median +39% metric:market `G7 beats-peers`

✓ **Recently funded** Last indexed round 8 months ago metric:months_since_last_round `G5 recent-raise`

✓ **Experienced founders** Mike Choi (Twitter/X, Apple, Google); Herrick Fang (Affirm) metric:founders `G6 notable-founders`

What would change the rating

- Answer: How much was the 2024 pre-seed? The release's total of more than $26 million exceeds the $25.5M in recorded rounds.
- A new round, a founder change or a status change in Crustdata's record

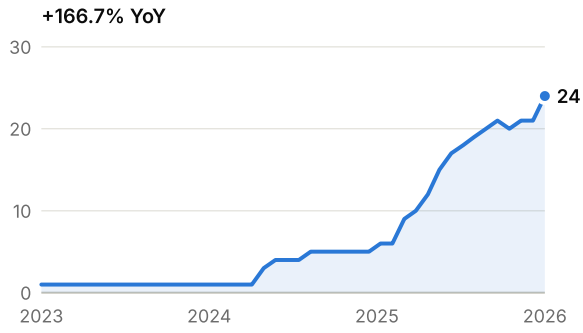
3 Growth and traction

Indexed signals over time. Values are as reported by the data provider; derived figures are plain calculations over the plotted points.

What the charts say

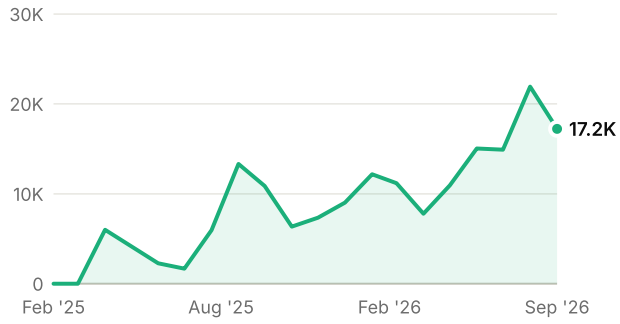
- Headcount moved from 1 (Feb 2023) to 24 (Sep 2026), +166.7% year on year.
- Web visitors: latest 17.2K/month (Sep 2026); peak 21.9K in Aug 2026.
- Followers: 2.2K, +733.7% over 12 months.
- Revenue estimate band: $0–$500K (an estimate range, not reported revenue).
- Largest function: Engineering at 35% of staff.
- Open roles listed: 7.

Headcount



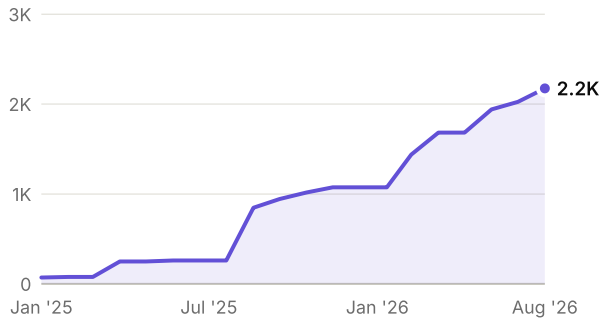
/company/enrich headcount.timeseries

Web visitors per month



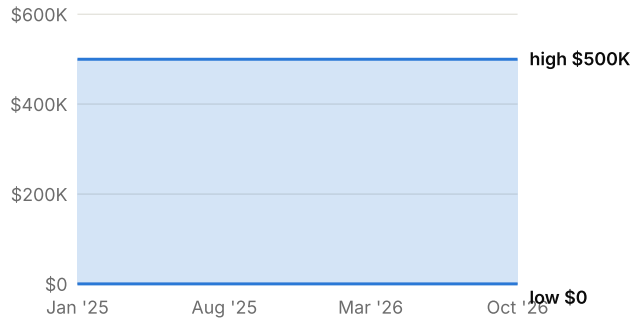
/company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['koahlabs.com'].monthly_visitors_timeseries

Followers



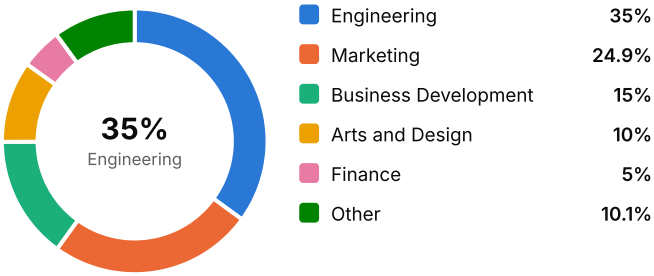
/company/enrich followers.timeseries

Revenue estimate band (USD)



/company/enrich revenue.estimated.timeseries

Role mix (% of staff)

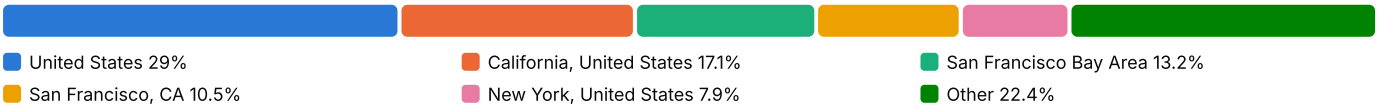


Signals role_mix

Hiring



Region mix (% of staff)



4 Team

Who runs the company, and whether the graph confirms they are where the sources say.

Founder profiles

FOUNDER	SINCE	PRIOR EMPLOYERS (NOTABLE HIGHLIGHTED)	PRIOR FOUNDER	EDUCATION	YRS EXP.
Mike Choi Co-Founder	Aug 2024	South Park Commons, X, Twitter, Apple, Google, Detroit Labs, Republic of Korea Army Twitter/X	—	Texas A&M University — Bachelor of Science (BS); Wichita Collegiate School	11.8
Nic Baird Co-Founder	2024	South Park Commons, Thinktiv, Thync Global, Inc., MarkSetBot, Halo Neuroscience	—	Yale University — B.A. with Distinction, Political Science and History; Shorecrest Preparatory School — High School; Stanford University Graduate School of Business — Auditor	9.2
Herrick Fang Co-Founder	2024	South Park Commons, Qualified (Acquired by Salesforce), Supermove, Affirm	—	Harvey Mudd College — Bachelor of Science, Mathematics and Computer Science	7.8

Verified team (Crustdata identity graph) G2 G3 G4

PERSON	CURRENT ROLE AT THE COMPANY	PRIOR EMPLOYERS NAMED BY SOURCES	SOURCE
Mike Choi person 2739857	✔ Co-Founder since 2024-08	none named by sources	people.founders
Nic Baird person 28237678	✔ Co-Founder since 2024	none named by sources	people.founders
Herrick Fang person 28232995	✔ Co-Founder since 2024	none named by sources	people.founders

✔ ID join: the employer ID on the person's record equals the company ID · ≈ name match only · ? not joined

5 Market and competition

How crowded the category is, and how the company's growth compares with funded peers.

CATEGORY
Advertising Platforms + Artificial Intelligence (AI)
Advertising · Advertising Platforms · Artificial Intelligence (AI) · Sales

NAICS
541810 Advertising Agencies

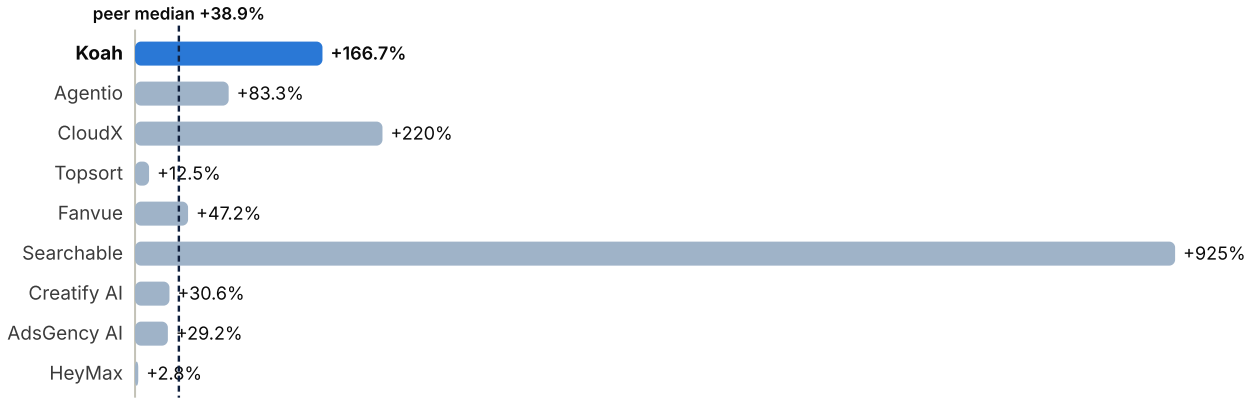
CROWDING
MEDIUM
1541 companies in category

FUNDED IN 24 MONTHS
72
peers that raised recently

Peer benchmark

COMPANY	FOUNDED	HEADCOUNT	HEADCOUNT YOY	TOTAL FUNDING	LAST ROUND
Agentio agentio.com	2023	77	+83.3%	$56.2M	Series B 18 Nov 2025
CloudX cloudx.ai	2025	48	+220%	$45.1M	Series A 13 Nov 2025
Topsort topsort.com	2021	144	+12.5%	$28.5M	Undisclosed round 24 Nov 2025
Fanvue fanvue.com	2021	184	+47.2%	$26M	Series A 16 Jan 2026
Searchable searchable.com	2025	41	+925%	$22.1M	Undisclosed round 18 May 2026
Creatify AI creatify.ai	2023	64	+30.6%	$18.5M	Undisclosed round 16 Sep 2025
AdsGency AI adsgency.ai	2023	31	+29.2%	$14.8M	Seed 20 Oct 2025
HeyMax heymax.ai	2023	37	+2.8%	$13.6M	Series A 28 Jan 2026

Headcount growth YoY: company vs peers



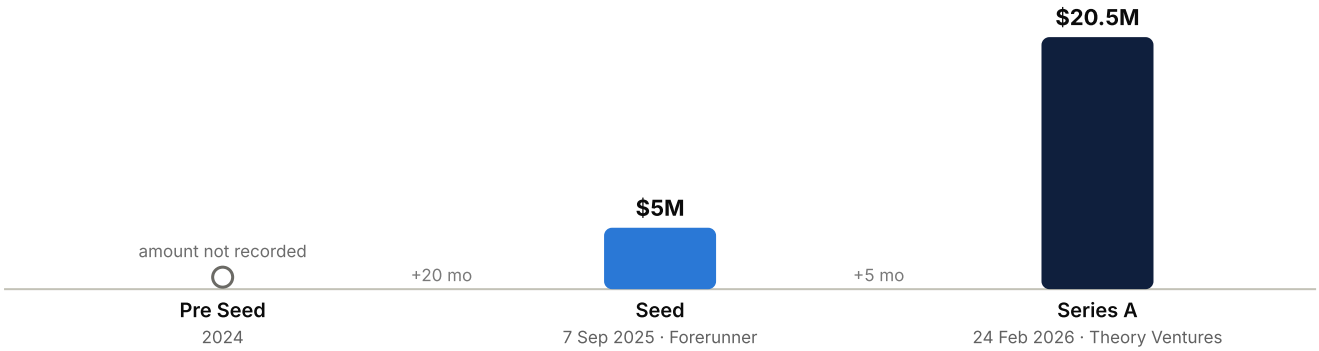
/company/search taxonomy.categories = 'Advertising Platforms' AND 'Artificial Intelligence (AI)', basic_info.year_founded >= 2020; funded = funding.last_fundraise_date >= 2024-10-01 (pool probes: Advertising Platforms=4113, Advertising Platforms + Artificial Intelligence (AI)=1541)

SEO overlap domains (noisy: keyword overlap, not verified competitors): koahai.com, apexautomationai.co.uk, kono-app.fr, koadigital.co, koahmedia.co

6 Financing and verified claims

Each sentence below passed the code check (every number against its cited evidence) and the entailment check.

Funding rounds by date (indexed record, Crunchbase-derived)



Hatched bars are secondary sales: liquidity for existing holders, not capital in the company. Year-only dates are shown at year precision.

Indexed series a: 2026-02-24, $20,500,000, Theory Ventures (indexed record, Crunchbase-derived). [G5]

Indexed seed: 2025-09-07, $5,000,000, Forerunner (indexed record, Crunchbase-derived). [G6]

Indexed pre seed: 2024, no amount recorded, lead not recorded (indexed record, Crunchbase-derived). [G7]

Total raised per Crustdata's record: $25,500,000 across 3 rounds; it equals the sum of the recorded round amounts (indexed record, Crunchbase-derived). [G8]

Verified claims

C1 SUPPORTED F3 · basis: company statement, indexed record (Crunchbase-derived) · as of 2026-02-24

Koah announced a $20.5M Series A led by Theory Ventures on 24 Feb 2026, and Crustdata's indexed record lists the same round. E1 G5

C2 SUPPORTED F2 · basis: company statement · qualified · as of 2026-02-24

Koah's release names Nic Baird as Co-Founder and CEO; his indexed profile lists him as Co-Founder at Koah without the CEO title. E2 G3

Limitation: The CEO title rests on the company's statement; the indexed profile shows only Co-Founder.

C3 SUPPORTED F3 · basis: independent report, indexed record (Crunchbase-derived) · as of 2025-09-07

TechCrunch reported that Forerunner led Koah's seed round with South Park Commons and Andrew Karam participating, and Crustdata's indexed record lists a $5M seed dated 7 Sep 2025 led by Forerunner. E3 G6

C5 SUPPORTED F3 · basis: independent report · as of 2025-09

TechCrunch reported on 7 Sep 2025 that Koah had recently raised $5 million in seed funding. E5 G6

WITHHELD

C4: suppressed by the sentence check (unsupported: "the Series A brings its total funding")

Questions for the founders

- How much was the 2024 pre-seed? The release's total of more than $26 million exceeds the $25.5M in recorded rounds.

Indexed news

FUNDING Koah Bags $20.5M Series A Round · vcnewsdaily.com 2026-03-03

FUNDING Koah, which embeds sponsored ads directly into AI chatbots and aims to build an AdSense for AI, raised a $20.5M Series A led by Theory Ventures (Trishla Ostwal/Adweek) · Techmeme 2026-02-25

FUNDING Koah Raises $20.5M To Scale AI-Native Advertising Platform · Ventureburn 2026-02-25

FUNDING Koah Raises $20.5M Series A Led by Theory Ventures to Scale AI-Native Monetization · Morningstar.com 2026-02-24

FUNDING Koah Raises $20.5M in Series A Funding · FinSMEs 2026-02-24

7 Methodology

How every number and status in this report was produced.

Pipeline

1. Identity: the domain resolves to one Crustdata company ID (a tie abstains).
2. Sources: the funding announcement and coverage are fetched; text addressed to AI agents is data, ignored.
3. Claims C1, C2…: material Team & Financing statements quoted verbatim from those sources.
4. Graph: founders' roles and prior employers joined by employer ID; rounds matched to the indexed record.
5. Gate: code checks every amount, percentage, year and date against cited evidence; an entailment check confirms each sentence. Failures are withheld, never repaired.
6. Signals and scoring: indexed growth, market and founder data feed five pillars and fixed flag rules.

Scoring model

Pillar weights: Team 25% · Traction 30% · Market 15% · Financing 15% · Verification 15%

Weighted score 85/100 → rating **INVEST**; confidence high. Suggested allocation = standard check × sizing ($100K × 100% = $100K).

This run: 3 documents, 13 evidence rows, 10 claims, 4 sentences emitted, 1 withheld, Crustdata credits 0.0 + signals 0.

Rules-based signal computed from public sources and Crustdata's indexed data (including estimates). It is not financial advice and does not replace diligence, references or legal review. Private-company financial statements are not public; revenue figures are third-party estimates.

Claims extracted

ID	QUOTE	STATUS
C1 D1 · F3	“today announced a $20.5 million Series A funding round led by Theory Ventures” · raised round	SUPPORTED
C2 D1 · F2	“said Nic Baird, Koah's Co-Founder and CEO” · holds title	SUPPORTED
C3 D2 · F3	“Koah’s seed round was led by Forerunner, with participation from South Park Commons and AppLovin co-founder Andrew Karam.” · led round	SUPPORTED
C4 D1 · F3	“The new capital brings Koah's total funding to more than $26 million” · total raised	WITHHELD
C5 D2 · F3	“Koah, which recently raised $5 million in seed funding” · raised round	SUPPORTED
C6 D1 · F3	“The round builds on Koah's $5 million seed round in September 2025” · raised round	not checked: same seed round as C5; C5 selected
C7 D3 · F3	“The round was led by Theory Ventures, with participation from Forerunner, South Park Commons, and AppLovin co-founder Andrew Karam.” · participated in round	not checked: same Series A as C1 (coverage of one announcement); selection cap
C8 D1 · F2	“Tomasz Tunguz, Founder and General Partner of Theory Ventures and Google AdSense alum, will join the Board” · other	not checked: board seat of an investor, not a founder role; lower materiality
C9 D1 · F3	“Backed by Theory Ventures, Forerunner, and South Park Commons” · backed company	not checked: investor list restates C1/C3
C10 D1 · F1	“Koah has already served more than 35 million native ad impressions across 175 million queries” · other	not checked: out of scope: traction metric, not Team & Financing

Flag rules (identical for every company; ×n = fired in this run)

CRITICAL `C1 identity` The domain did not resolve to exactly one Crustdata company

CRITICAL `C2 conflict` Comparable sources contradict each other on a selected claim

CRITICAL `C3 record-differs` An announced round differs from Crustdata's indexed record

CRITICAL `C4 founder-no-role` A founder listed by Crustdata has no current role at the company

CRITICAL `C5 legal-news` Indexed news mentions a lawsuit, fraud, investigation, breach, settlement, regulator probe or bankruptcy

CRITICAL `C6 not-active` Crustdata lists the company as not active

RED `R1 headcount-decline` Headcount fell more than 10% year on year (or 15% in 6 months)

RED `R2 traffic-decline` Web visitors fell more than 30% year on year (or 25% in 3 months)

RED `R3 crowded-market` 100+ peers in the same category raised money in the last 24 months

RED `R4 stale-funding` More than 24 months since the last round and the team is not growing

RED `R5 lagging-peers` Headcount growth trails the peer median by more than 30 points

RED `R6 thin-team` Fewer than 5 people more than 2 years after founding

RED `R7 revenue-down` The estimated revenue band moved down over the series

RED `R8 layoffs-news` Indexed news mentions layoffs or a shutdown

AMBER `A1 verification-open` A claim is qualified, corrected, not established or withheld **×2**

AMBER `A2 secondary-total` The indexed total includes secondary sales (liquidity, not capital)

AMBER `A3 data-gap` A key data group is missing, so part of the score is a default

AMBER `A4 regulated-sector` The company's NAICS code is in a regulated sector

AMBER `A5 revenue-vs-capital` Capital raised is 20x or more the upper bound of the revenue estimate (early revenue for the money raised) **×1**

GREEN `G1 verified-round` An announced round matches the indexed record **×2**

GREEN `G2 team-joined` Every listed founder holds a current role at the company (ID join) **×1**

GREEN `G3 strong-growth` Headcount grew more than 30% year on year **×1**

GREEN `G4 traffic-growth` Web visitors grew more than 30% year on year

GREEN `G5 recent-raise` Raised in the last 12 months **×1**

GREEN `G6 notable-founders` A founder previously founded a company or worked at a notable tech company or scaleup **×1**

GREEN `G7 beats-peers` Headcount growth beats the peer median by more than 20 points **×1**

GREEN `G8 audience-growth` Followers grew more than 50% year on year **×1**

Data sources

CRUSTDATA ENDPOINT	MODE	STATUS	CALLS
`/company/enrich`	FIXTURE	200	2
`/company/identify`	FIXTURE	200	2
`/company/search`	FIXTURE	200	3
`/job/search`	FIXTURE	200	1
`/person/search`	FIXTURE	200	1
`/web/enrich/live`	FIXTURE	200	1

Signal fields: `/company/enrich followers.count`, `/company/enrich followers.timeseries`, `/company/enrich followers.yoy_percent`, `/company/enrich funding.milestones`, `/company/enrich funding.milestones (indexed record (Crunchbase-derived))`, `/company/enrich funding.total_investment_usd`, `/company/enrich headcount.by_function_timeseries.CURRENT_FUNCTION.Business Development`, `/company/enrich headcount.by_function_timeseries.CURRENT_FUNCTION.Engineering`, `/company/enrich headcount.by_function_timeseries.CURRENT_FUNCTION.Marketing`, `/company/enrich headcount.by_role_percent.Engineering`, `/company/enrich headcount.growth_percent.mom`, `/company/enrich headcount.growth_percent.qoq`, `/company/enrich headcount.growth_percent.six_months`, `/company/enrich headcount.growth_percent.two_years`, `/company/enrich headcount.growth_percent.yoy`, `/company/enrich headcount.timeseries`, `/company/enrich headcount.total`, `/company/enrich people.founders`, `/company/enrich public_launches.launches`, `/company/enrich revenue.estimated.lower_bound_usd/upper_bound_usd`, `/company/enrich revenue.estimated.timeseries`, `/company/enrich revenue.public_markets`, `/company/enrich seo.monthly_organic_clicks`, `/company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['koahlabs.com'].monthly_visitors`, `/company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['koahlabs.com'].monthly_visitors_timeseries`, `/company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['koahlabs.com'].qoq_pct`, `/company/search taxonomy.categories = 'Advertising Platforms' AND 'Artificial Intelligence (AI)', basic_info.year_founded ⩾ 2020; funded = funding.last_fundraise_date ⩾ 2024-10-01 (pool probes: Advertising Platforms=4113, Advertising Platforms + Artificial Intelligence (AI)=1541)`, `/job/search aggregations.count`, `/job/search aggregations.count (company.basic_info.company_id = 3718859)`, `computed from /company/enrich funding.milestones (indexed record (Crunchbase-derived)) vs 2026-10-31`, `computed from /company/enrich funding.milestones[].funding_date (indexed record (Crunchbase-derived))`, `computed from /company/enrich headcount.timeseries`, `computed from /company/enrich revenue.estimated.timeseries`, `computed from /company/enrich web_traffic.domain_traffic['koahlabs.com'].monthly_visitors_timeseries`, `computed: total_funding_usd / headcount_total`

DOC	WEB FETCH SOURCE	ORIGIN	PUBLISHED	UPDATED	RETRIEVED
D1	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/koah-raises-20-5m-series-a-led-by-theory-ventures-to-scale-ai-native-monetization-302695002.html	company (press release)	2026-02-24	2026-02-26	2026-10-31
D2	https://techcrunch.com/2025/09/07/koah-raises-5m-to-bring-ads-into-ai-apps/	unknown	2025-09-07	2025-09-14	2026-10-31
D3	https://www.finsmes.com/2026/02/koah-raises-20-5m-in-series-a-funding.html	unknown	2026-02-24	2026-07-30	2026-10-31

Evidence

ID	SOURCE · LOCATOR	VALUE
E1	prnewswire.com/news-releases/ko... `D1[407:484]`	SAN FRANCISCO, Feb. 24, 2026 /PRNewswire/ -- Koah, which enables contextual advertising natively inside generative AI, today announced a $20.5 million Series A funding r... · company (press release)
E2	prnewswire.com/news-releases/ko... `D1[940:981]`	"Generative AI has changed how people consume information, and monetization must evolve alongside it," said Nic Baird, Koah's Co-Founder and CEO. · company (press release)
E3	techcrunch.com/2025/09/07/koah-... `D2[3217:3338]`	Koah's seed round was led by Forerunner, with participation from South Park Commons and AppLovin co-founder Andrew Karam. · unknown

ID	SOURCE · LOCATOR	VALUE
E4	prnewswire.com/news-releases/ko... `D1[2950:3018]`	Koah is introducing analytics tools to track user engagement and ad performance inside AI search and chat, alongside new context-rich ad formats built specifically for g... · company (press release)
E5	techcrunch.com/2025/09/07/koah-... `D2[86:140]`	A startup called Koah, which recently raised $5 million in seed funding, is betting that ads will be a big part of the answer. · unknown
G1	/company/identify `matches[0].company_data.crustdata_company_id`	Koah = 3718859 (primary_domain == koahlabs.com, confidence 1.0) · Crustdata identity graph
G2	/company/enrich `people.founders[Mike Choi].experience.employment_details.current`	Mike Choi (person 2739857): Co-Founder at Koah 3718859, since 2024-08 · Crustdata identity graph
G3	/company/enrich `people.founders[Nic Baird].experience.employment_details.current`	Nic Baird (person 28237678): Co-Founder at Koah 3718859, since 2024 · Crustdata identity graph
G4	/company/enrich `people.founders[Herrick Fang].experience.employment_details.current`	Herrick Fang (person 28232995): Co-Founder at Koah 3718859, since 2024 · Crustdata identity graph
G5	/company/enrich `funding.milestones[0]`	series_a, 2026-02-24 (day), $20,500,000, lead Theory Ventures · indexed record (Crunchbase-derived)
G6	/company/enrich `funding.milestones[1]`	seed, 2025-09-07 (day), $5,000,000, lead Forerunner · indexed record (Crunchbase-derived)
G7	/company/enrich `funding.milestones[2]`	pre_seed, 2024 (year), amount not recorded, lead not recorded · indexed record (Crunchbase-derived)
G8	/company/enrich `funding.total_investment_usd`	$25,500,000 · indexed record (Crunchbase-derived)

Limitations

- C4: suppressed by the sentence check (unsupported: "the Series A brings its total funding")
- Funding figures are an indexed record (Crunchbase-derived), not independent confirmation.
- Index lists a stock ticker without an IPO date; treated as private (private: ticker KOAH in the index has no IPO date (treated as a namesake)).
- Revenue band and web traffic are third-party estimates, not reported figures.
- News kinds are a title-keyword heuristic; indexed news can include namesakes.
- Peers are companies tagged 'Advertising Platforms + Artificial Intelligence (AI)' (Crustdata taxonomy), founded 2020 or later; the category match is coarse and is not a verified competitor set.
- SEO competitor domains are raw keyword overlaps (often namesakes), not a verified competitor list.
- No data for field group: hiring
- No data for field group: employee_reviews
- No data for field group: software_reviews
- No data for field group: market_intel
- No data for field group: metadata